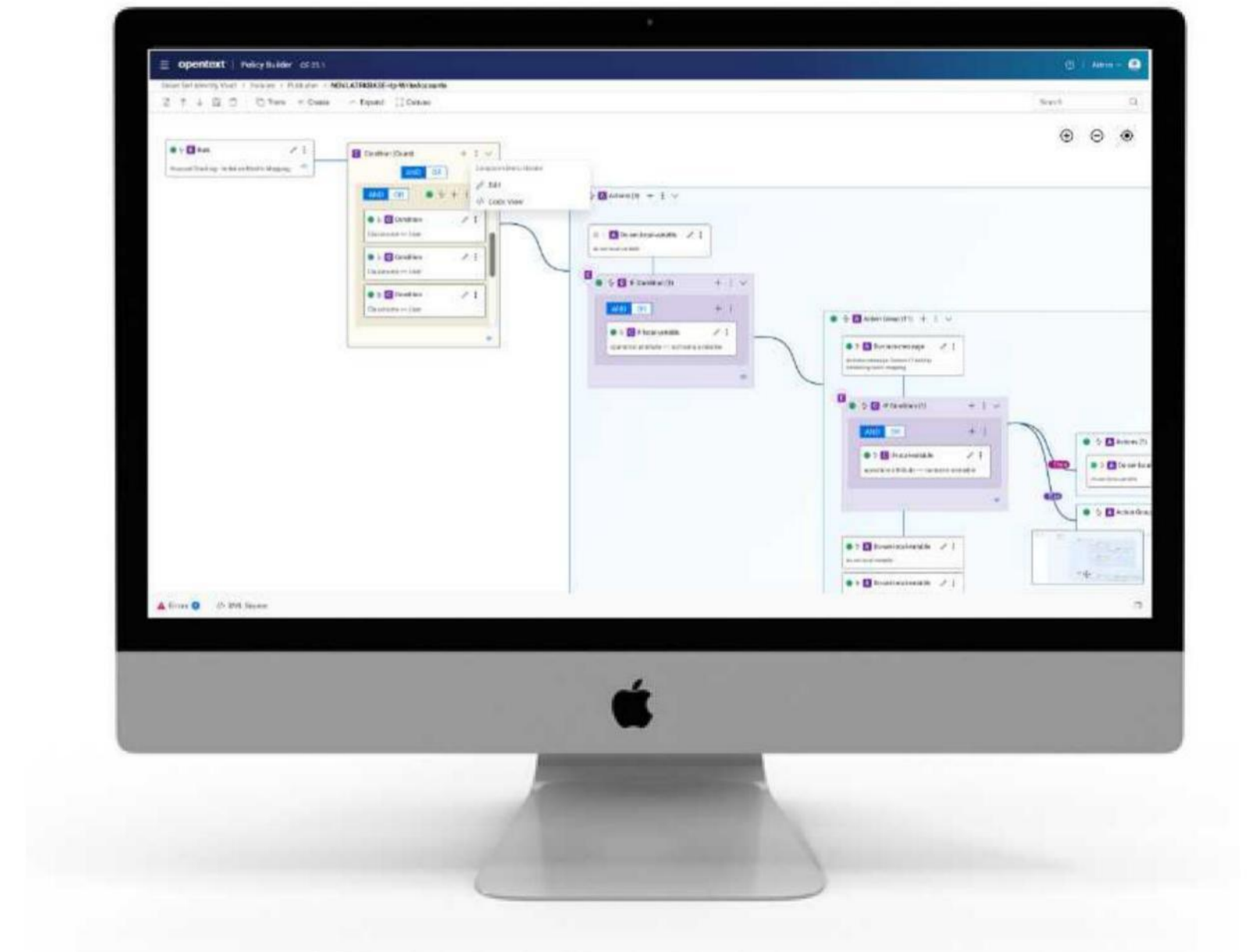


ILM Policy Editor

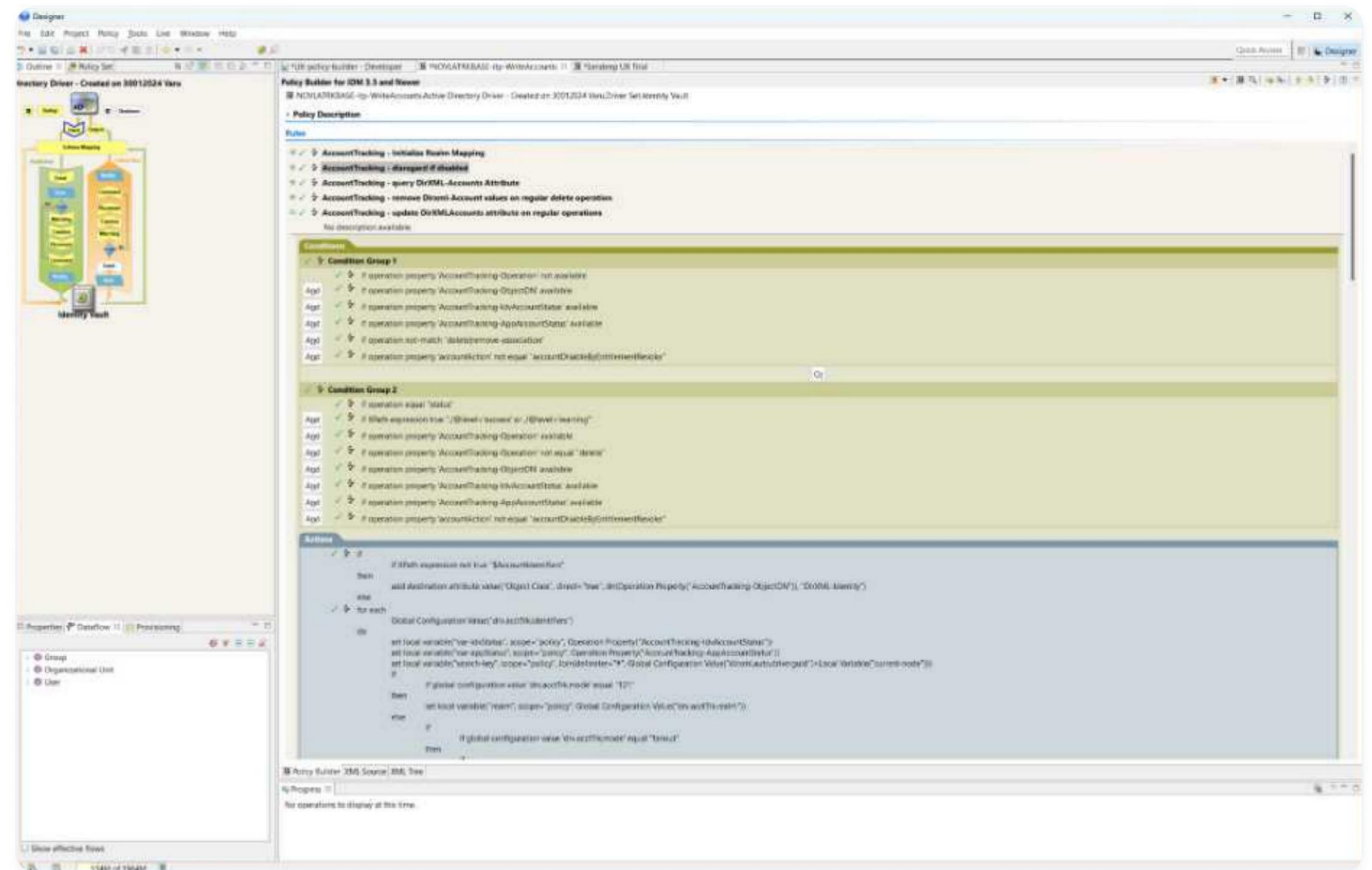
Sandeep Virmani, Principal User Experience Designer

April 2026, OpenText Identity Lifecycle Manager, Cybersecurity



What is the Policy Builder?

A tool used by enterprise IT administrators to define, edit, and manage identity policies — the rules that govern how user data flows between systems.



The old IED tool for creating and maintaining policies

Defining the Problem and the Path Forward

Enterprise administrators had stopped trying to self-serve their identity policies — they just called a consultant...*"I set out to understand why, then design a way out of it."*

The Problem

XML-only editing locked non-technical admins out

My Approach

Research-led redesign with 5 enterprise customers

The Outcome

Visual policy editor validated by 9 customers at OTW2025

Why Self-Service Failed

This is what administrators were working with.

Nested modals

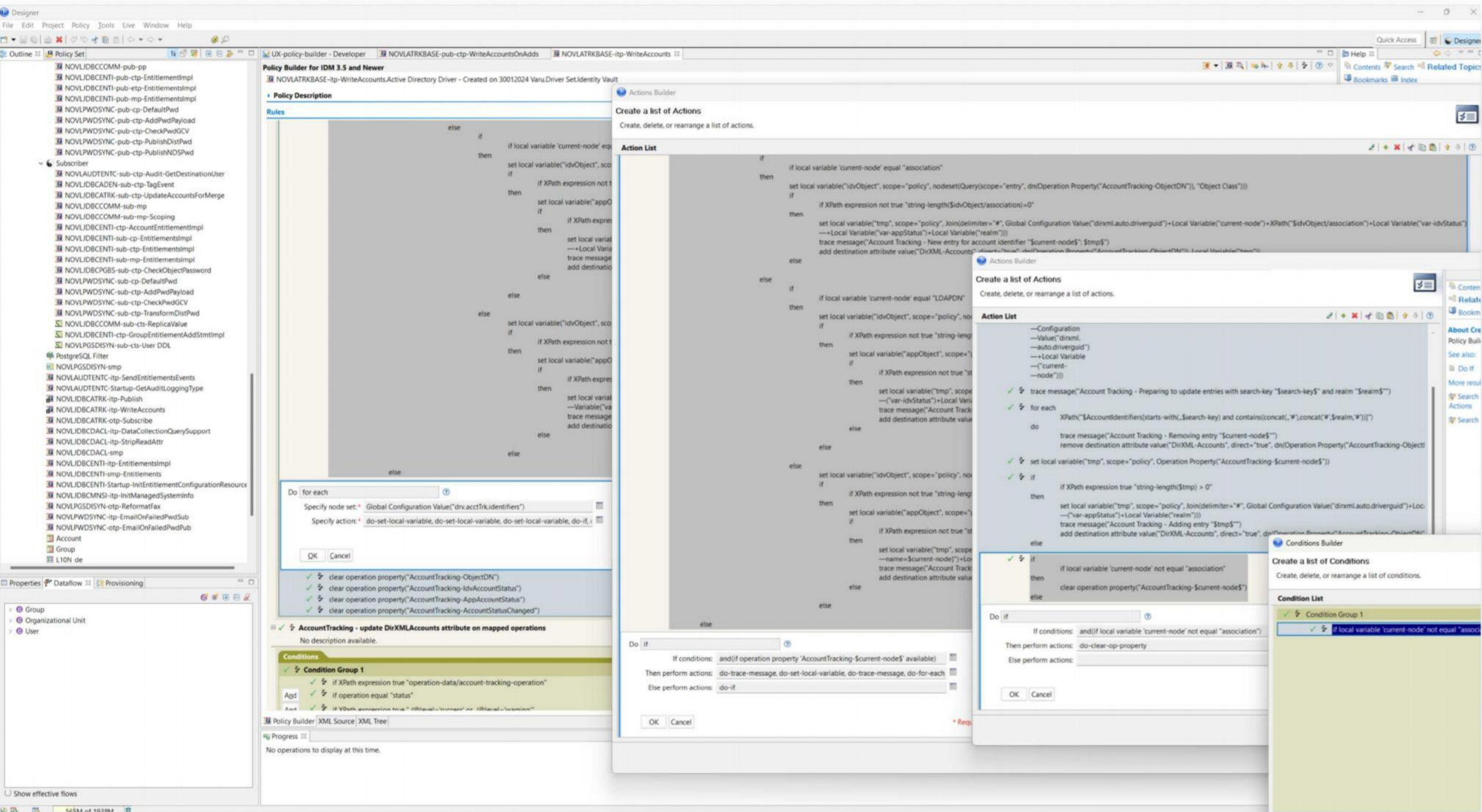
Conditions and actions each opened separate dialogs — no unified workspace.

XML-only editing

No visual layer. Every rule, condition, and action lived in raw XML.

No spatial hierarchy

The policy structure wasn't visible—users could only interpret syntax, not relationships or flow.



The Modal Trap: Navigating 4+ layers of dialogs that break the mental model of the policy.

Persona: The Enterprise Policy Administrator



"I shouldn't need a consultant just to make a simple change to a policy."

Astrid Fischer

Application Administrator (IT Operations / IAM)

Context

Astrid manages identity synchronization policies in a large enterprise environment using NetIQ Identity Manager. She ensures integrations remain stable across connected systems such as Active Directory.

Primary Goal

Maintain secure, reliable identity synchronization between the Identity Vault and external applications.

Key Pain Points

Economic Friction

High dependency on consulting for routine policy updates.

Cognitive Load

Nested modal workflows caused frequent context loss.

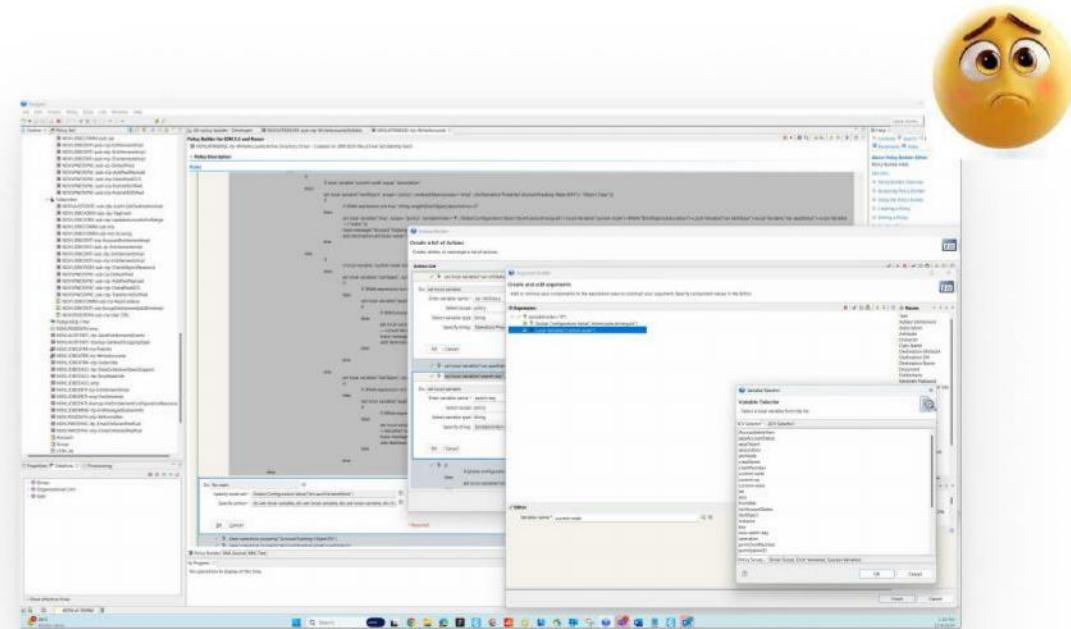
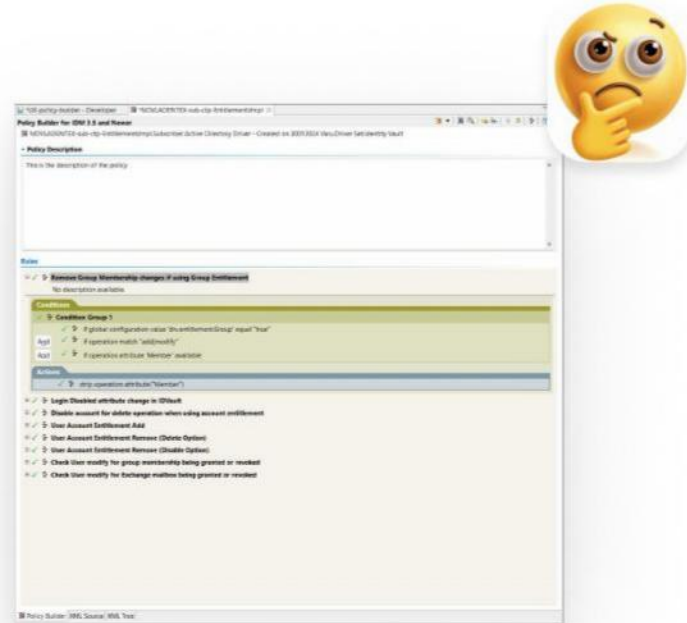
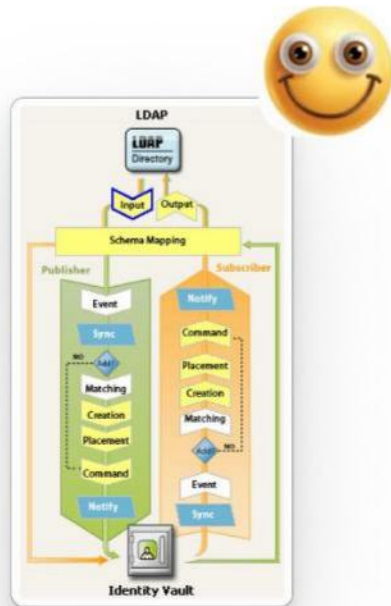
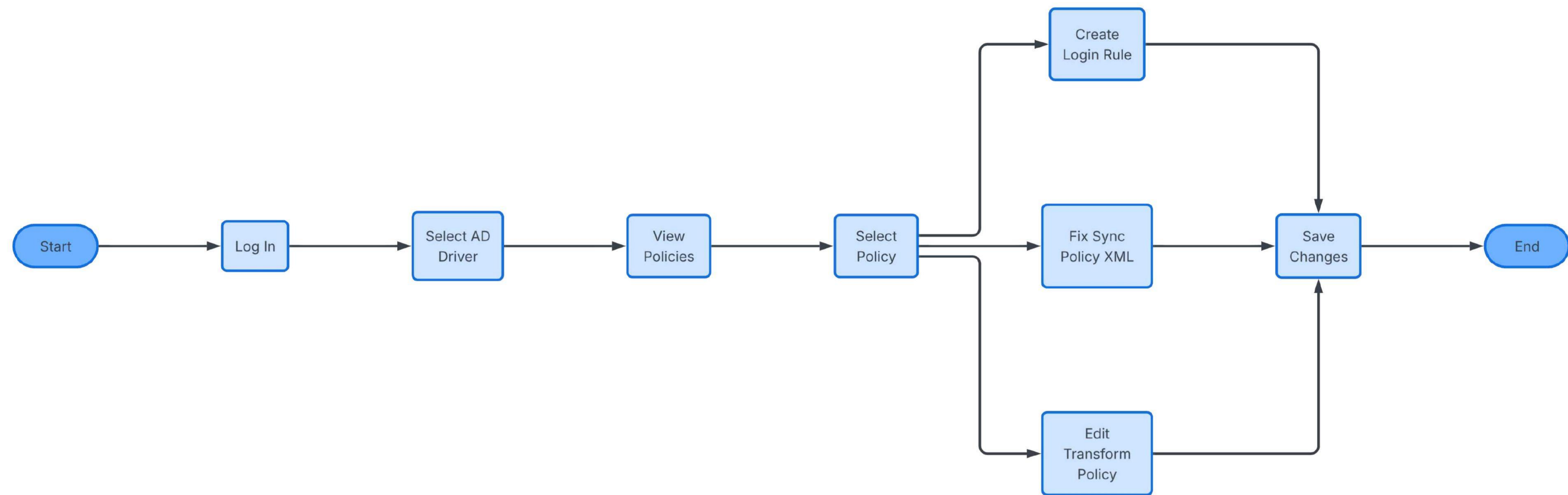
Technical Risk

Manual XML editing increased errors and configuration instability.

Lack of Policy Visualization

No visual structure to compare rules or validate policy logic.

Astrid: Journey Map



How I Investigated It ?



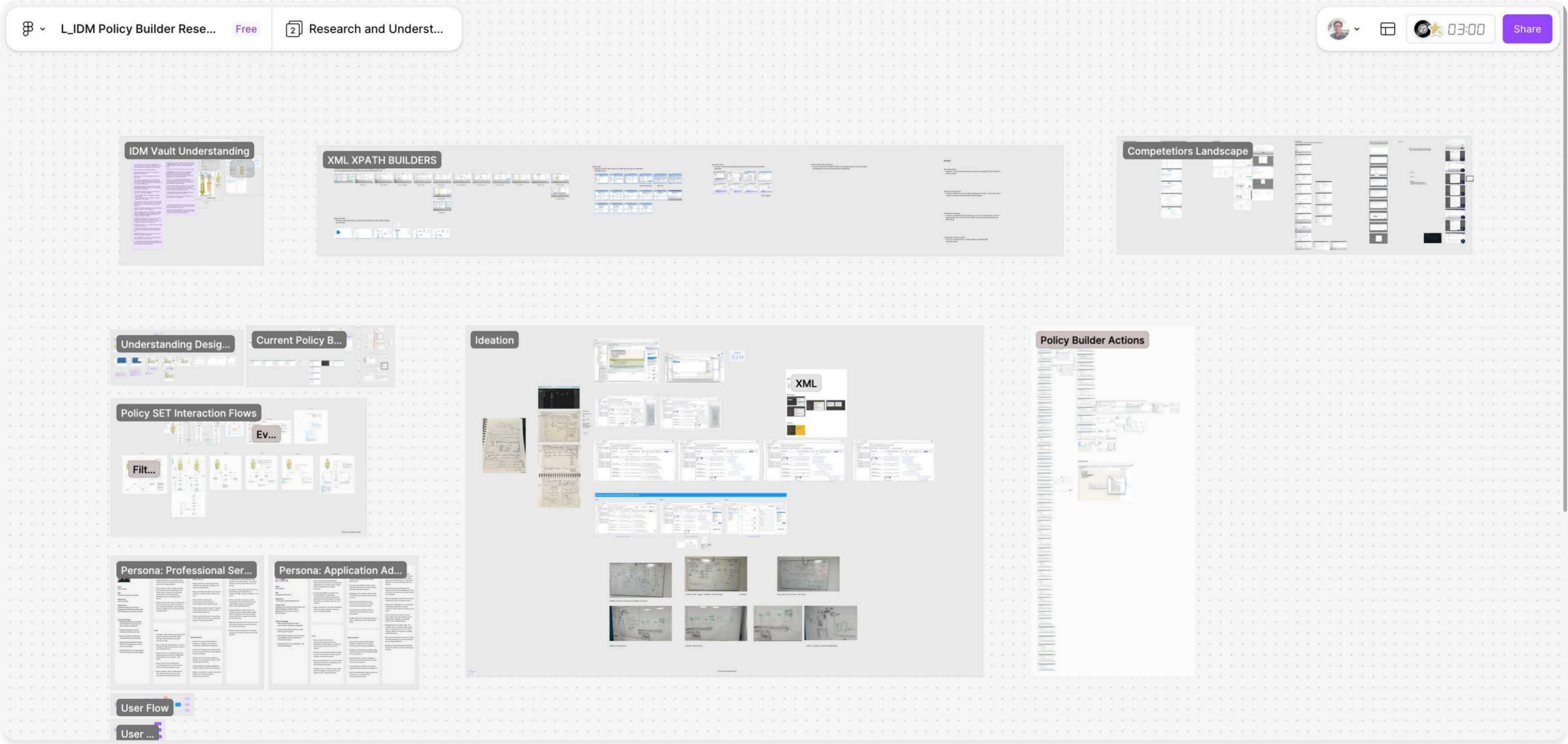
Remote stakeholder session — reviewing system flows

Method	What it gave me
Contextual Inquiry	Observed admins in live environments — saw real workarounds, not reported ones
Stakeholder Interviews	3–4 sessions with key stakeholders across enterprise organisations
Think-Aloud Protocol	Surfaced decision-making and confusion points in real time

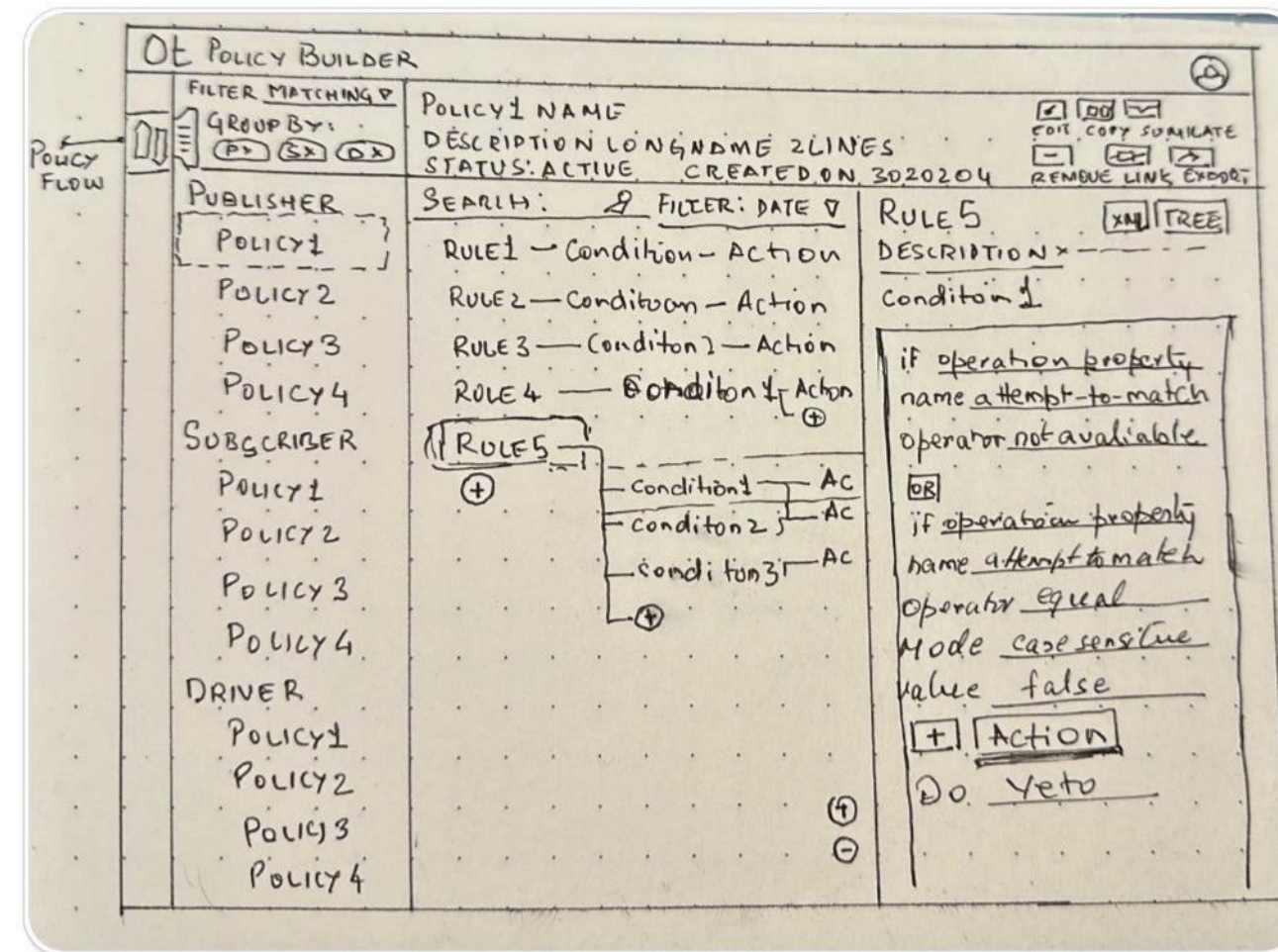
Research Goals

1. Can admins use the GUI without XML expertise?
2. Does it support real-time sync workflows?
3. Does it reduce consultant dependency?
4. Does it help prevent and recover from errors?
5. Does it support team collaboration?

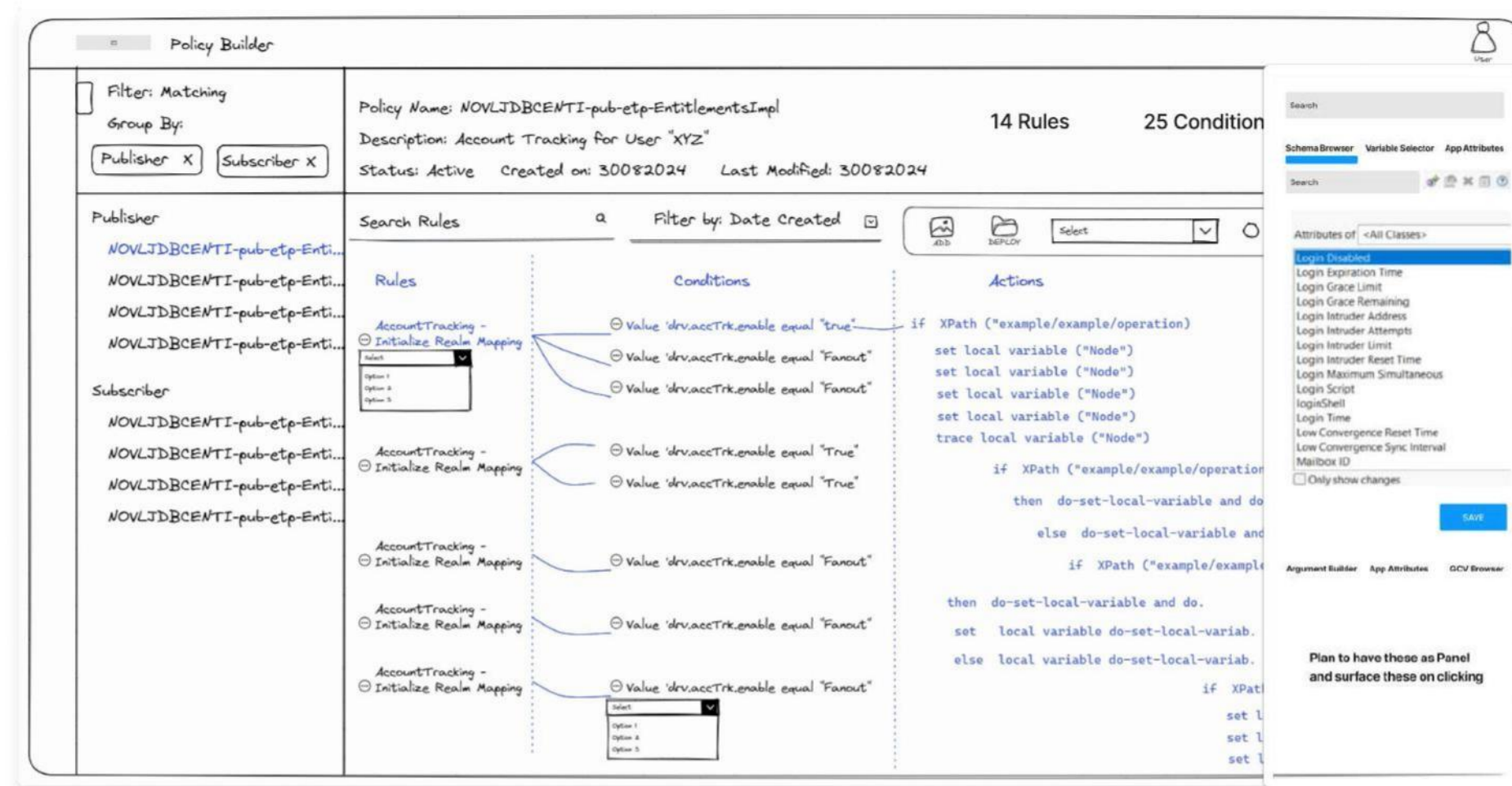
Let me show you the research board.



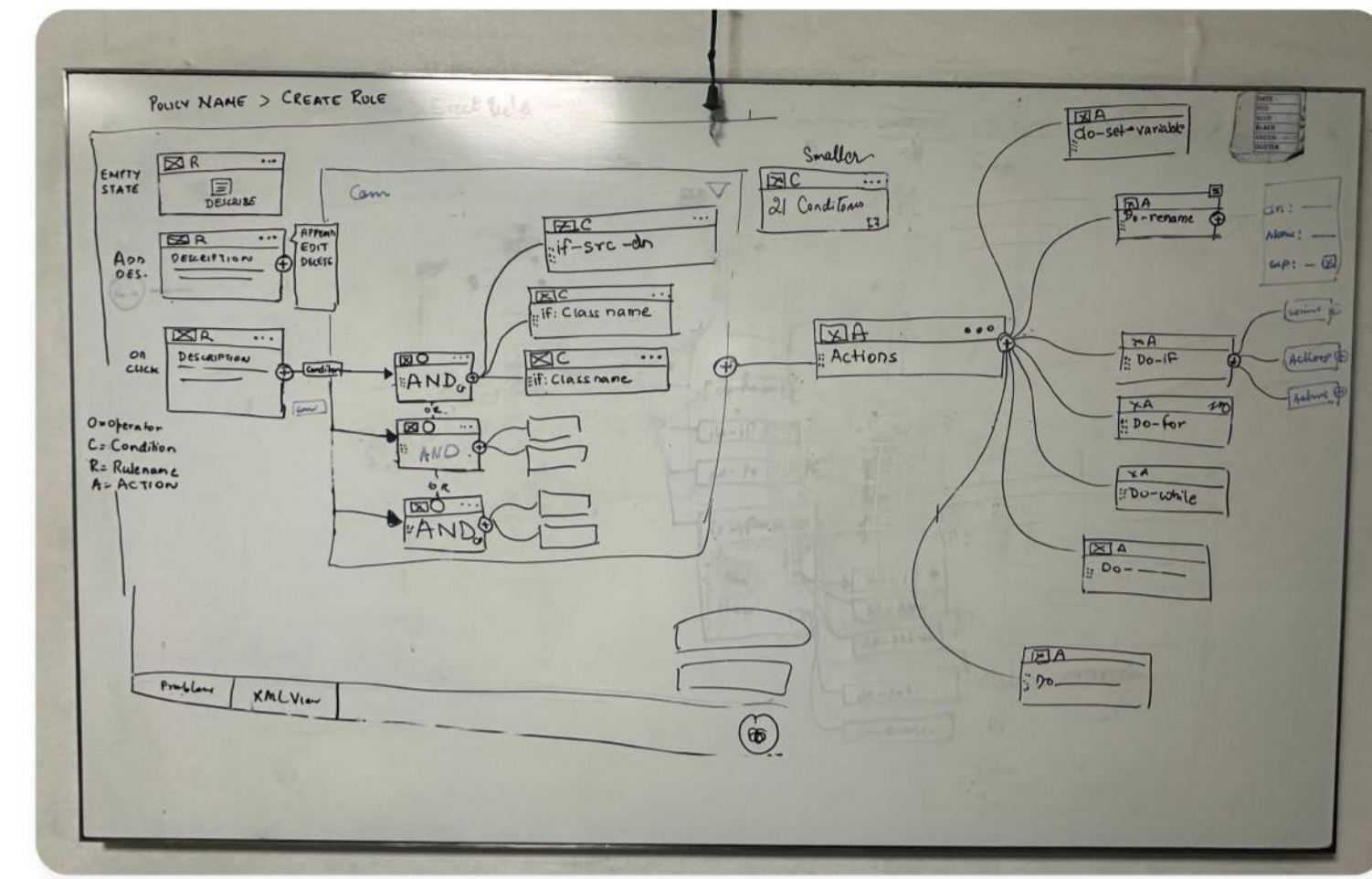
The Process



Early structure thinking



First wireframe direction



Whiteboard flow mapping

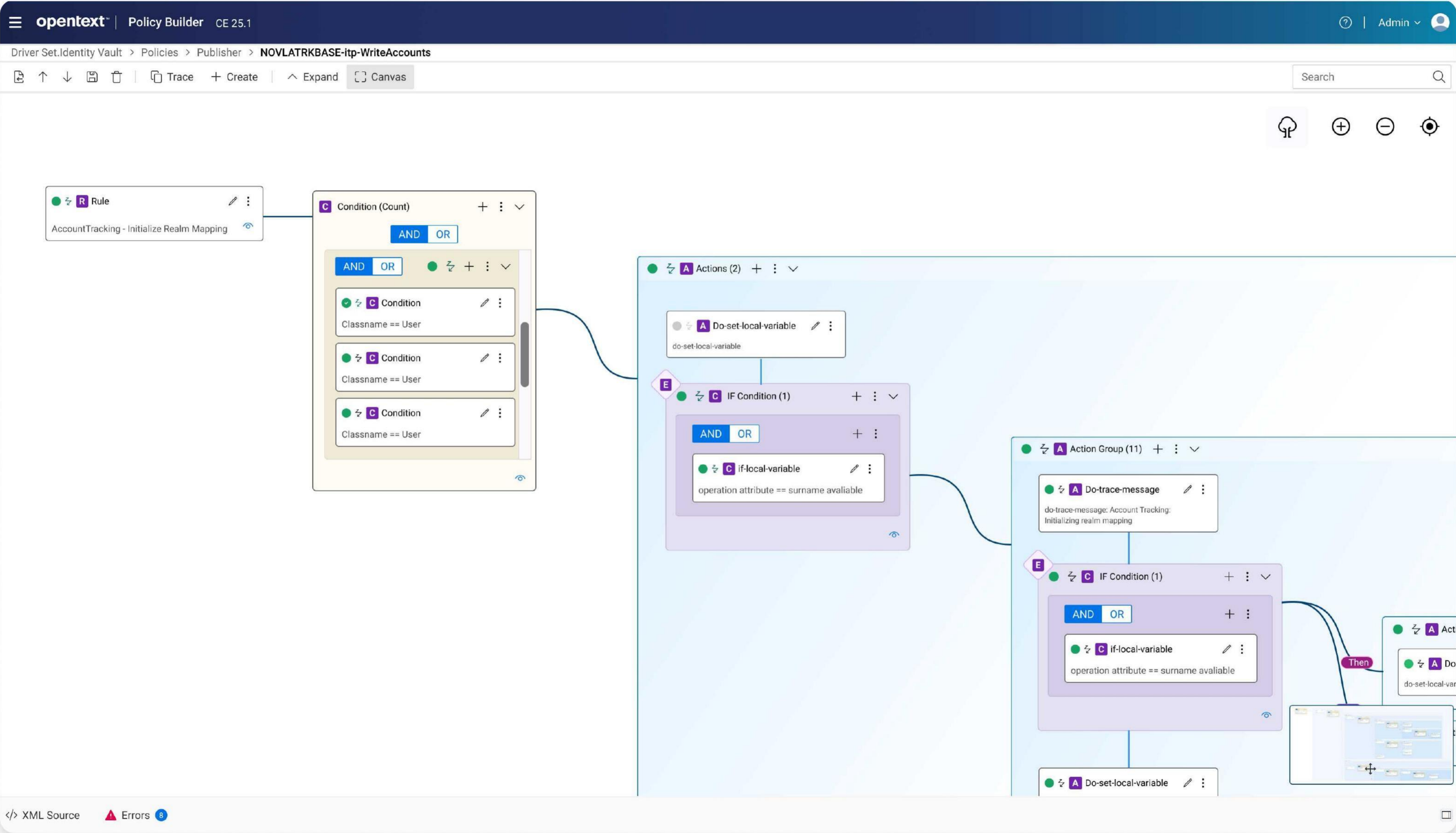
Three principles that came out of ideation:

Visual over syntactic — Rules should be seen, not read as XML

Context-preserving — Never make the user leave their workspace to edit

Progressive disclosure — Simple for new admins, deep for power users

This is where it came together



First canvas concept — conditions, actions, and AND/OR logic all visible simultaneously for the first time.

First Contact — Early Prototype Validation



Partner group session — Bangalore

Before finalising the design, we brought partners in to test an early prototype. This wasn't a polished usability test — it was a directional check.

What they validated:

Canvas View — The visual approach landed. Node-to-node structure was immediately understood.

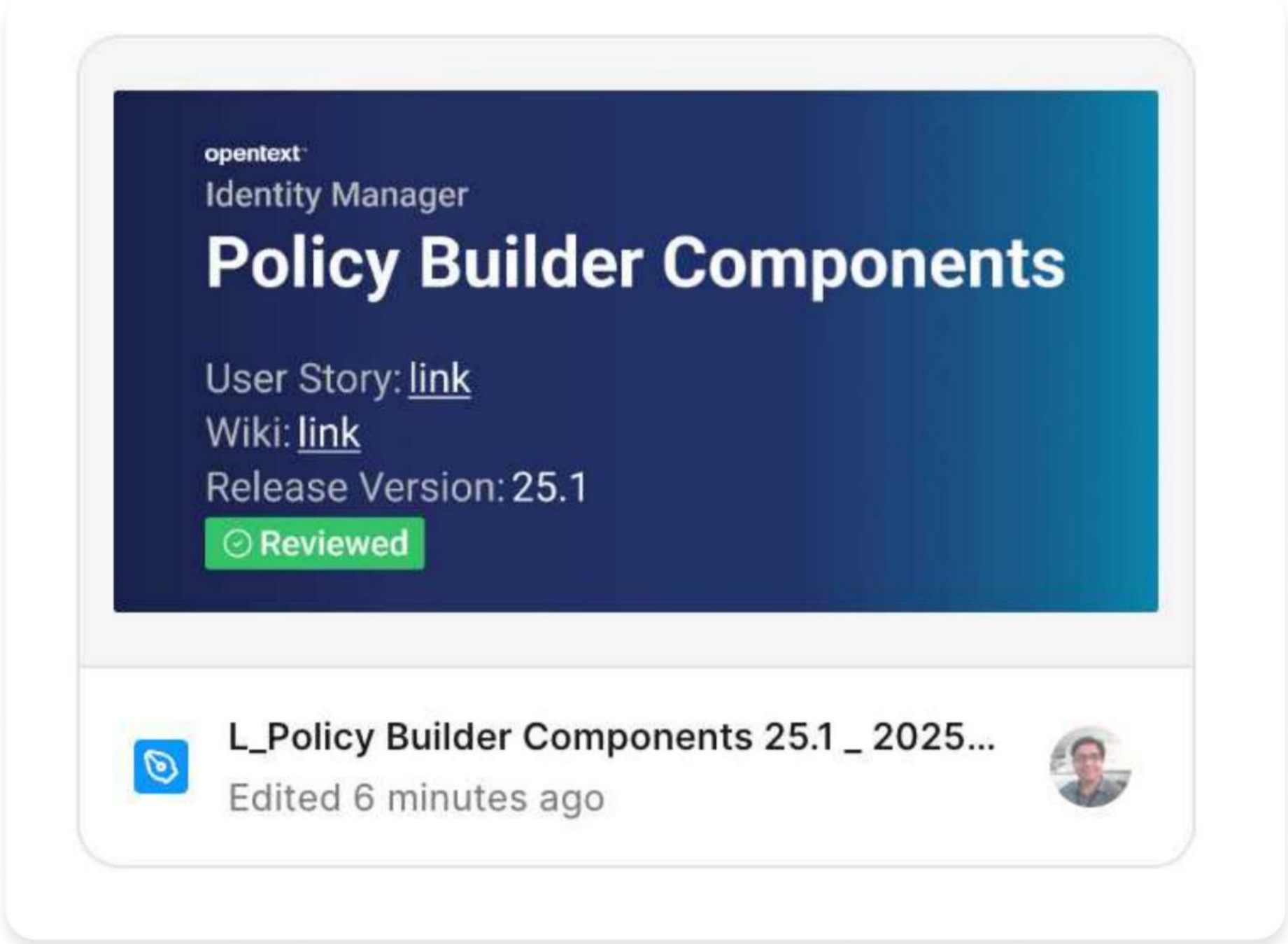
What they pushed beyond:

Nested policies — Partners wanted to see deeper nesting handled more clearly

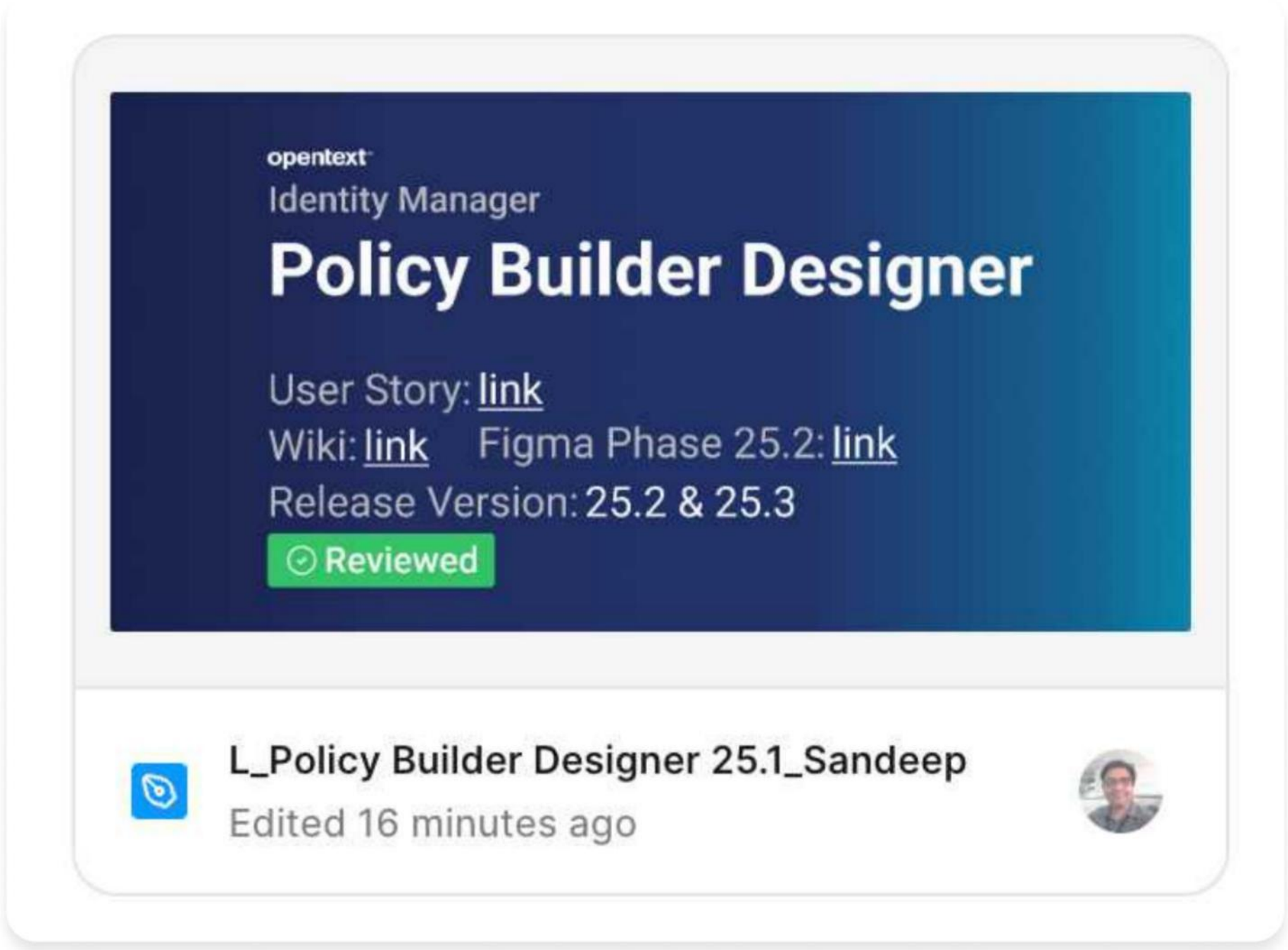
XML indented view — Expected a structured, readable XML alongside the canvas

Pseudo-code view — Some partners wanted a plain-language summary of what a policy does

Now let me show you how it was built.



[↗ Component Library — Figma Link](#)



[↗ Interactive Prototype — Figma Link](#)

User Experience Design Policy Builder

IDM Policy Builder by Sandeep Virmani

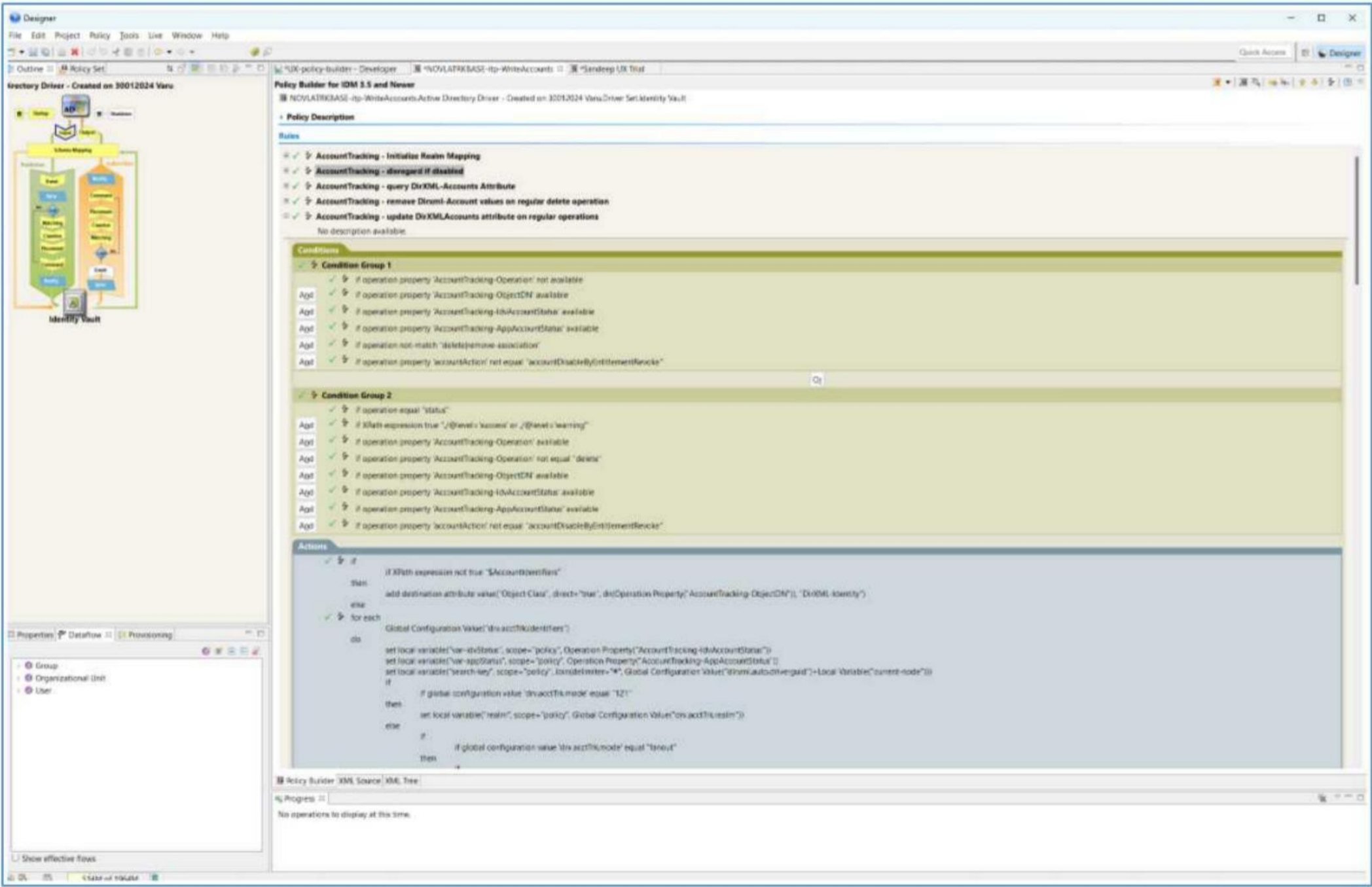
Principal User Experience Designer OpenText, Dec 2024

Understanding the Policy Builder

The Policy Builder is a complete graphical interface for creating and managing the policies that define the exchange of data between connected systems.

The Policy Builder enables you to add, view, and delete the rules that make up a policy.

You can also use it to import and save policies and rules, and manage XML namespaces. The Policy Builder contains the Action Builder and the Condition Builder.



Designs records

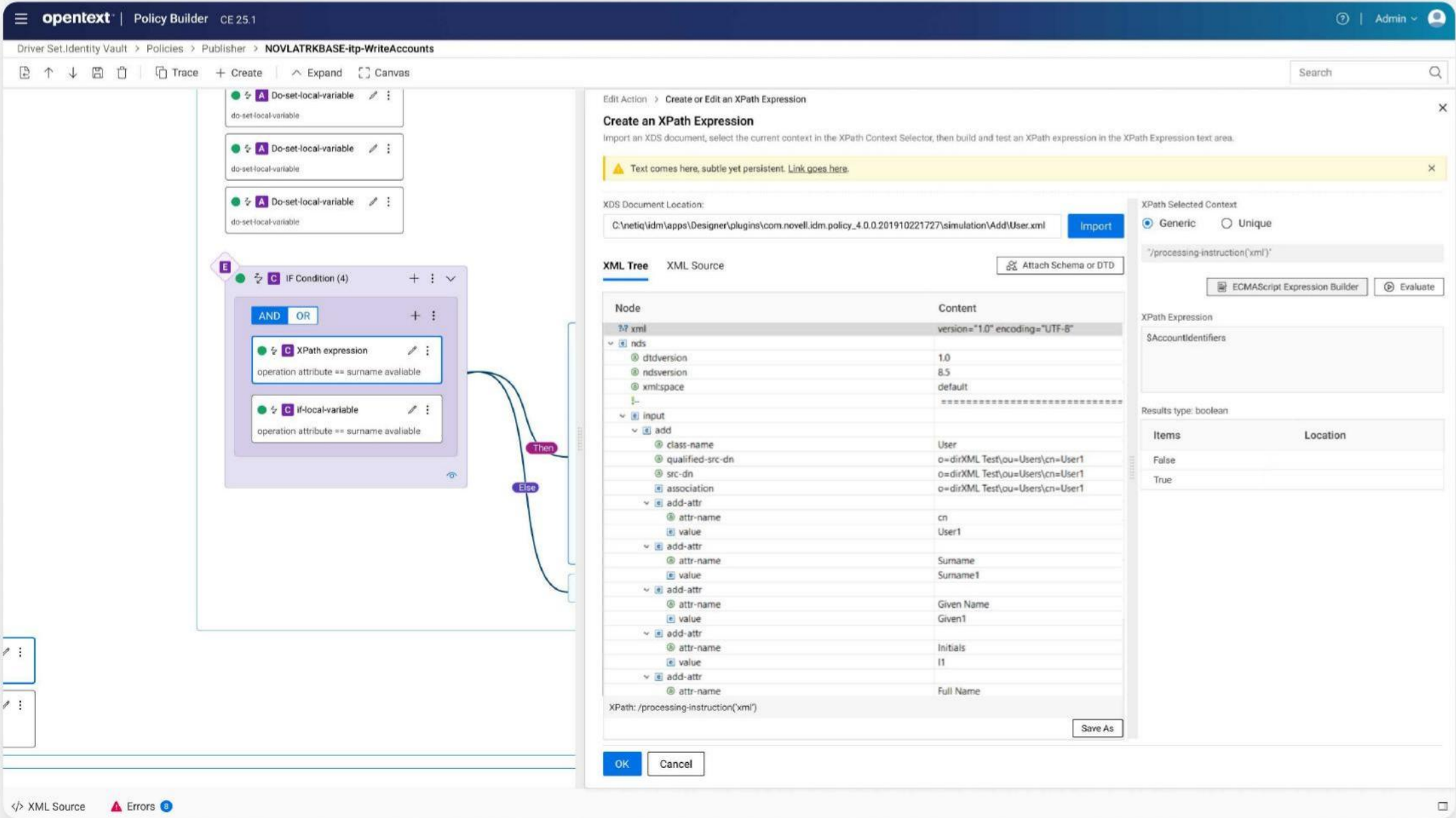
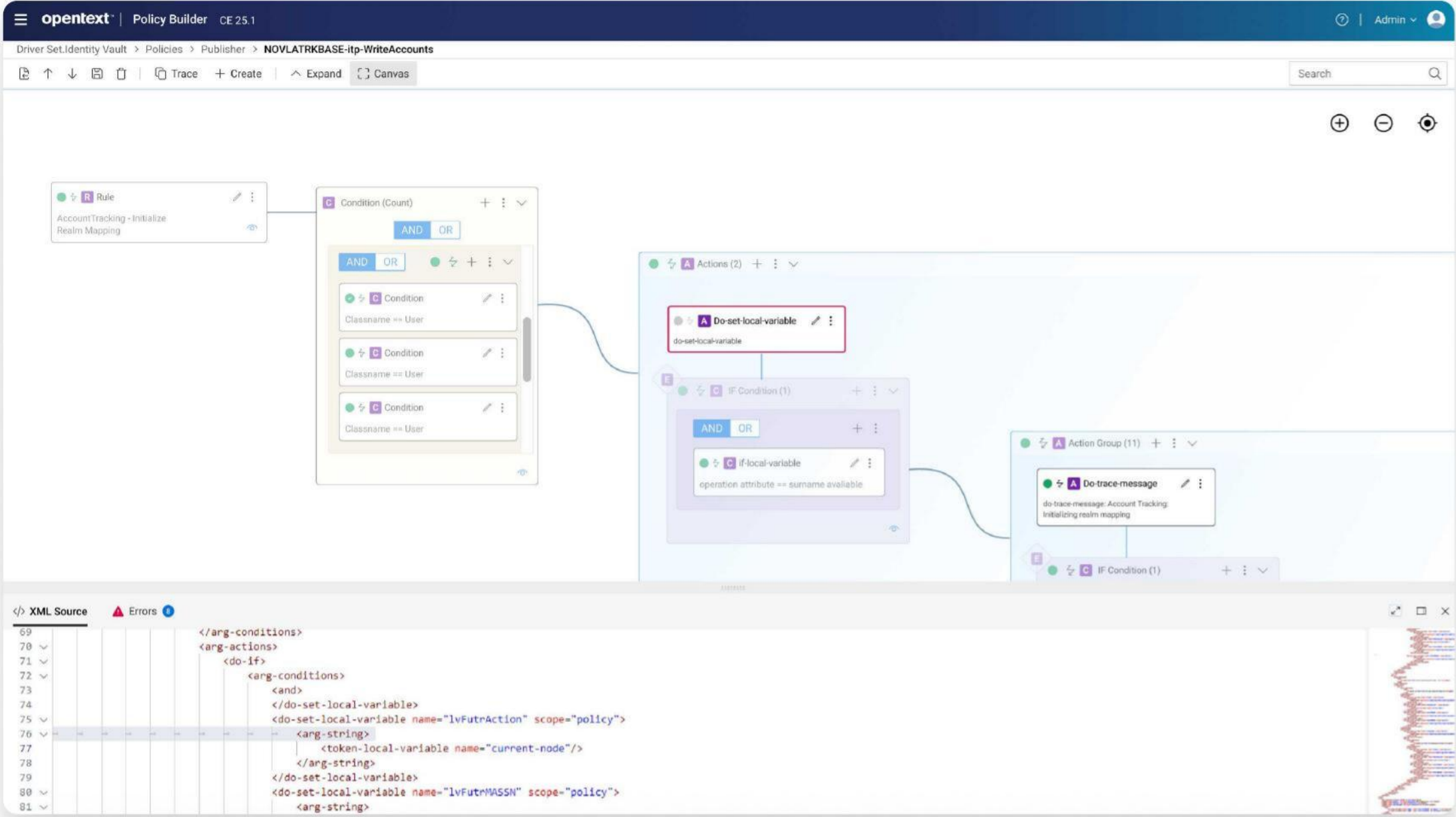
A living document — updated weekly throughout the project.

Every decision, every feedback session, every iteration was documented here in real time. Not a retrospective — a working record that kept the entire team aligned.

Weekly updates — Research findings logged as they happened

Stakeholder alignment — Meeting notes and decisions captured in real time

Single source of truth — One place for the whole team to reference



The Final Solution — Canvas View

Canvas View

Visual, card-based rule editor.
Node-to-node structure. No modals.

XML Tree View

Sidecar panel. Click any node — canvas highlights it instantly.

XML Source View

Full XML access for power users.
Node-level or full policy view.

Nested policies

Deep structures navigable within the same canvas

AND/OR logic toggle

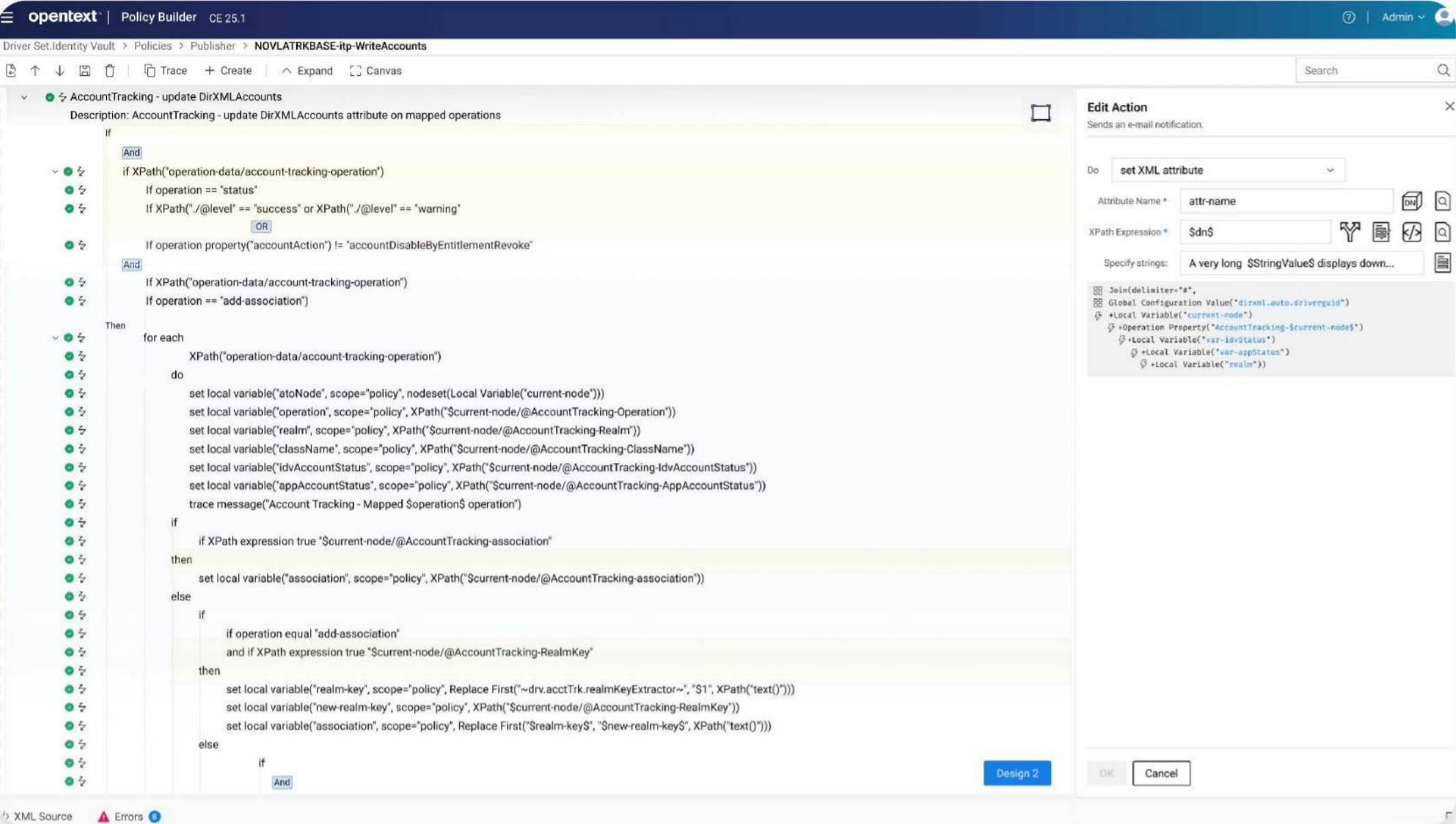
Condition groups switchable inline,
no separate dialog

Error panel

Bottom of canvas, toggleable, real-time validation

Breadcrumb navigation

Edit Action → Name String Builder →
Argument Builder



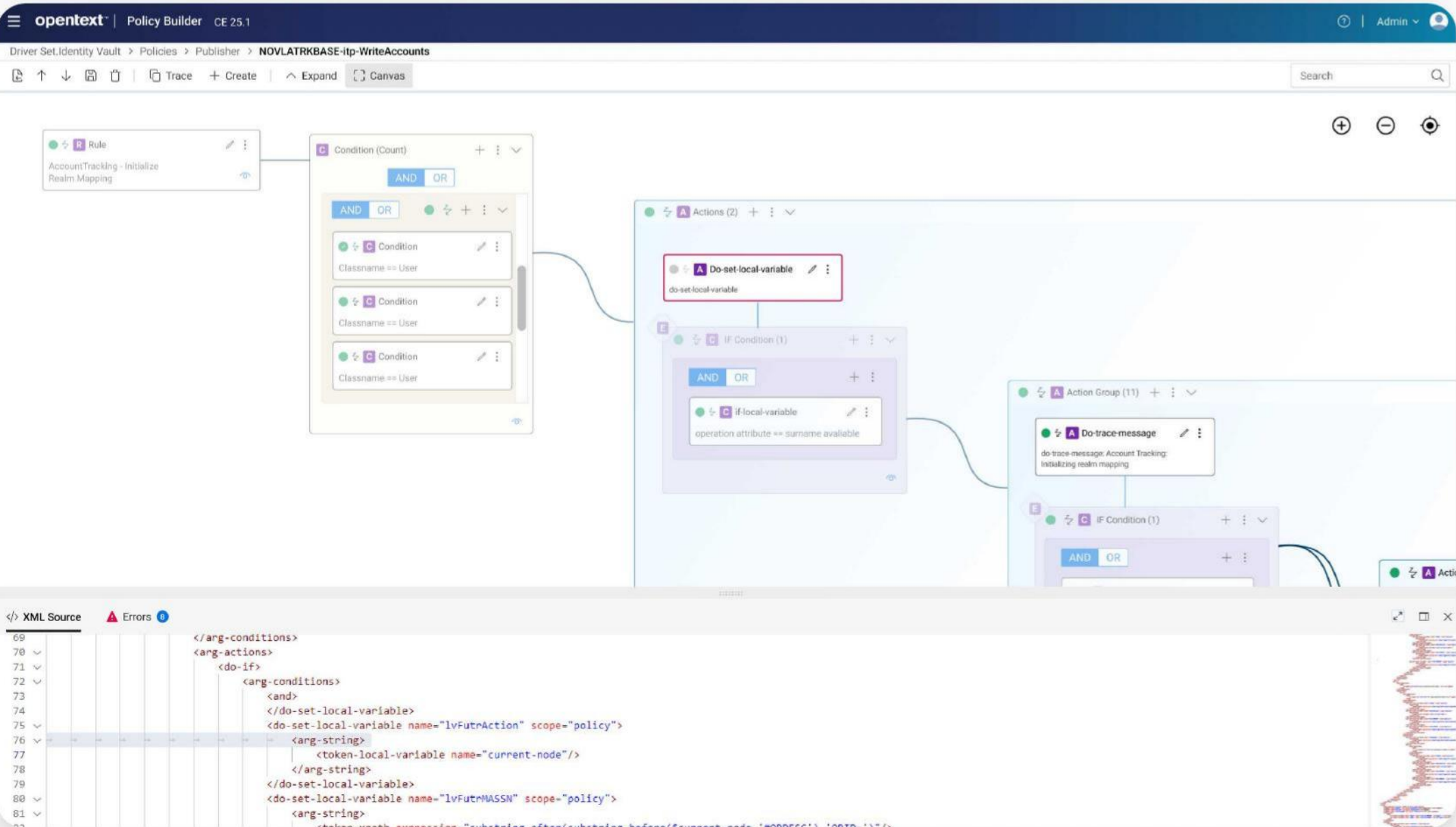
From Feedback to Functionality

Pseudo-code overlay

Logic gets lost in the boxes; I need to 'read' the policy.

Integrated XML Tree View

The canvas is great, but I still need to verify the raw XML for debugging.



Node highlight

I need to see which node belongs to which condition and actions

Validating at Scale — OpenText World 2025

Transition from internal testing to global customer validation in Nashville.

[↗ OTW Deck](#)

83%

Effectiveness:

74

SUS score

0

Critical issues

50+

UX Issues resolved

Beyond the UI — Shifting the Product Culture

Validation from Research and Engineering Leadership



Shane Melton  · 1st

UX Research & AI Experience Strategy Leader | Enterprise UX Systems, Human-AI Interaction, ResearchOps at Scale
March 31, 2026, Shane worked with Sandeep on the same team

Sandeep is the gold standard for how a Designer should partner with UX Research. While preparing for a high-stakes customer event at OpenText World 2025, Sandeep's proactive approach saved our team weeks of lead time. He arrived at our first meeting with a fully-realized 10-page testing plan, allowing us to hit the ground running immediately.

Beyond his organizational leadership, Sandeep's design acumen is exceptional. The prototype he provided was pixel-perfect, with interactions that so accurately reflected the end product that our usability findings carried a much higher level of internal confidence. This technical precision ensured that the feedback we gathered was both highly robust and immediately actionable for the product team.

Throughout the process, he was a seamless collaborator—managing stakeholder syncs and meticulously refining his work to ensure the best possible research outcomes. I highly recommend Sandeep for any role that requires a rare combination of strategic initiative and elite design execution.



Outstanding contributions to the Innovation Lab

It was a pleasure to work with Sandeep in preparing the Identity Lifecycle Manager Policy Builder usability test for this year's Innovation Lab at OTW2025. From the beginning of our preparations, Sandeep prepared a highly detailed document, including the goals to be accomplished and the tasks that we wanted to address in the Lab. This document was instrumental in preparing the test script we used. He also worked diligently to ensure that the test environment was ready and met the needs of the test. Finally, he managed constant communications among all stakeholders on the team to ensure that everyone was on the same page regarding the goals of the test and even helped recruit participants to "test the test" prior to the event. As a result of Sandeep's contributions, the test and preparations ran very smoothly. We were able to collect feedback from 9 customers and partners during the Lab. All of these participants left feeling very happy to impact product designs through their feedback.

Subject: Appreciation for Sandeep's Contributions to Policy Editor, ILM UI ownership & JATO Initiatives

Sent: Monday, September 15, 2025 12:20 PM

Hi Mahesh,

I would like to take a moment to recognize **Sandeep** for his excellent contributions and commitment.

Sandeep consistently demonstrates strong collaboration and dependability. He is always available to support the team and is regarded as a reliable contributor who ensures tasks are driven to closure effectively.

While working on the **Policy Editor**, one of the most complex configuration modules, Sandeep quickly adapted, understood the requirements thoroughly, and contributed with high energy and enthusiasm. His technical expertise and adaptability stood out during this effort.

He has also been proactive in designing multiple **UX screens**, iterating on them based on feedback, and showing a strong commitment to user experience and design quality. By engaging with stakeholders, conducting thorough reviews, and constructively incorporating feedback, he has consistently ensured high-quality outcomes. The new **Policy Editor** has successfully addressed most of the drawbacks in our earlier product, Designer. Its user experience and implementation have been highly appreciated by several VPs and Senior Directors during their recent visit to India.

Sandeep took full ownership of the **ILM UI**, representing it effectively during reviews with the Accessibility team. His ability to articulate and address concerns with clarity and precision built confidence among stakeholders.

In the **JATO enablement initiative**, he played a key role by analysing page-level complexities, collaborating with stakeholders, and creating a clear implementation plan. His recent UX work for **Policy Simulation** is fully JATO-enabled, reflecting his ability to tackle technical challenges and deliver scalable solutions.

Overall, Sandeep's dedication, ownership, and technical acumen have made a significant impact, and I deeply appreciate his contributions.

Regards

Rahul

Appreciation from Engineering Director

Reflections & The Path Forward

Advocating for the User

Building the business case for a "Canvas-First" architecture over a simple XML fix.

Bridging the Engineering Gap

Moving the needle from "technical debt" to "product innovation" through cross-functional alignment.

The Trust Equation:

Navigating the tension between power users and simplicity; proving that Transparency (XML Tree) = Trust.

Managing Cognitive Load

Organizing complexity rather than stripping it away, ensuring power users feel in control.

Operational Impact:

Standardizing research documentation that optimized global testing at OpenText World.

Successfully shifted the product culture from 'XML-First' to 'User-First,' establishing a scalable architecture ready for AI-assisted orchestration.